blubabyshow

FREE PRINTABLE

Blu's Feelings Cards

10 big feelings to name together

for little ones 2–5 and their grown-ups



- print at home
- cut on the lines
- play together

Printing tips & the no-duplex fold method: page 9

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How to use your cards

Little ones feel big things before they have the words. These cards give you both the words. Two or three cards and a few minutes together is plenty.



Front Blu shows the feeling. Say the word together, then write it in your language.

Back Name it: words you can say. Try this: one calming or cuddle idea. Ask: one question.

1 Pick a calm moment

Look at the cards when things are quiet: on a lap, after a nap, at bedtime. In the middle of a meltdown, stay close and keep words few. Talk about the card later.[1]

2 Name it, then wait

Point to Blu and say the word: “Blu looks frustrated.” Then pause. Little ones often don’t have words for big feelings yet, and that is one common reason tantrums happen.[2]

3 Talk in your language

Write the word in your home language on the dotted line. Ask the question on the back and listen. In one study, children’s gains in understanding feelings went with parents talking about a show with them, not with watching more.[3]

4 Again and again

Come back to favourite cards over many days. Repeats are good: in one study, 3-year-olds learned new words better from the same stories read again than from new ones.[4]

Big feelings are a normal part of being little. Tantrums happen most between ages 1 and 3 and tend to get better after 3.[5] If you are ever worried, talk to your child’s doctor. These cards are for play and connection; they are not a medical or therapy tool.

[1] Child Mind Institute, “How to handle tantrums and meltdowns”: don’t try to talk a child through it while they can’t take it in. childmind.org/article/how-to-handle-tantrums-and-meltdowns

[2] KidsHealth (Nemours), “Temper tantrums”: tantrums peak in the second year while language is developing; a limited vocabulary for feelings is one trigger. kidshealth.org/en/parents/tantrums.html

[3] Rasmussen et al. 2016, Daniel Tiger’s Neighborhood field study (n=127, ages 2–6), via Texas Tech summary: gains in empathy and emotion recognition were tied to parents’ conversations about the show, not to more viewing.

[4] Horst, Parsons & Bryan 2011, Frontiers in Psychology 2:17: 3-year-olds hearing the same stories repeated learned more new words than those hearing different stories.

[5] American Academy of Pediatrics, HealthyChildren.org, “Temper Tantrums”.



happy

in my language: .....

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sad

in my language: .....

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angry

in my language: .....

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scared

in my language: .....

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This page goes on the back of page 3 (flip on long edge). Cut from the fronts side.



sad

Blu's Feelings Cards

Name it

"You look sad. Your balloon floated away."

Try this

Sit close and offer a cuddle. You don't need to fix it. Just stay near.

Ask

"Would a hug help?"

2 / 10 blubabyshow



happy

Blu's Feelings Cards

Name it

"You look happy! Your friend came to play."

Try this

Do a happy dance together: wiggle, clap, jump, then finish with a big squeeze.

Ask

"What makes you smile?"

1 / 10 blubabyshow



scared

Blu's Feelings Cards

Name it

"You look scared. That thunder was so loud!"

Try this

Hold them close and breathe slowly together. Whisper, "I'm here. You're safe."

Ask

"What helps you feel safe?"

4 / 10 blubabyshow



angry

Blu's Feelings Cards

Name it

"You're angry. It's time to go, and you want to stay."

Try this

Stomp it out together like big elephants: stomp, stomp, STOMP! Then flop down and breathe.

Ask

"Do you want to stomp, or squeeze a pillow?"

3 / 10 blubabyshow

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surprised

in my language: .....

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frustrated

in my language: .....

blubabyshow



shy

in my language: .....

blubabyshow



proud

in my language: .....

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This page goes on the back of page 5 (flip on long edge). Cut from the fronts side.



frustrated

Blu's Feelings Cards

Name it

"You look frustrated. The tower fell down."

Try this

Blow it out together: a big breath in, then blow out slowly, like blowing out birthday candles.

Ask

"Shall we try again together?"

6 / 10 blubabyshow



surprised

Blu's Feelings Cards

Name it

"You look surprised! A bubble landed on your nose!"

Try this

Play peekaboo together: hide behind your hands, then pop out with a big "Oh!"

Ask

"Was it a happy surprise or a scary one?"

5 / 10 blubabyshow



proud

Blu's Feelings Cards

Name it

"You look proud! You put your shoes on all by yourself."

Try this

Celebrate together: a high five, a happy wiggle, or a big "Yay, you!"

Ask

"Can you show me how you did it?"

8 / 10 blubabyshow



shy

Blu's Feelings Cards

Name it

"You feel shy. There are lots of new people here."

Try this

Let them hold your hand and watch for a while. They can join in when they're ready.

Ask

"Shall we watch together first?"

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calm

in my language: .....

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jealous

in my language: .....

blubabyshow

draw a face
for your feeling

I feel .....

in my language: .....

blubabyshow

draw a face
for your feeling

I feel .....

in my language: .....

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This page goes on the back of page 7 (flip on long edge). Cut from the fronts side.



jealous

Blu's Feelings Cards

Name it

"You feel jealous. You want a turn on my lap too."

Try this

Special time: five minutes, just the two of you. No phone. Let them choose the game.

Ask

"What shall we play, just you and me?"

10 / 10 blubabyshow



calm

Blu's Feelings Cards

Name it

"You look calm. Your body feels soft and slow."

Try this

Teddy breathing: lie down, rest a soft toy on each tummy, and watch it rise and fall.

Ask

"Can you breathe slowly, like Blu?"

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my own feeling

make your own card

Name it

"You look .....

Try this

Ask

blubabyshow

my own feeling

make your own card

Name it

"You look .....

Try this

Ask

blubabyshow

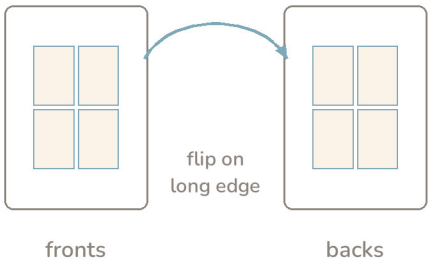
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Print, cut & fold

1 Print

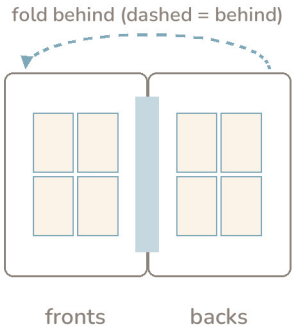
Print at Actual size (100%), not “Fit to page”, so each card is 63 × 88 mm. Thick paper or card (160–300 gsm) works best. You need pages 3 to 8 for the cards.

A · Double-sided printer



Print pages 3–8 double-sided and choose “flip on long edge”. Each BACKS page lands behind its FRONTS page, already mirrored to line up.

B · No duplex? The fold



Print pages 3–8 on one side. Lay a FRONTS page and the BACKS page after it face up, side by side, fronts on the left, edges touching. Tape the join. Fold the backs page behind the fronts page, so both printed sides face out. Line up the corners and glue the blank sides together.

2 Cut ✂

Cut along the dashed lines on the FRONTS side. The small marks at the edges help you line up a ruler or paper trimmer. Cutting is a grown-up job.

3 Make them last

Laminate the cards, or slip them into standard 63 × 88 mm card sleeves. Round the corners with scissors so they are soft for small hands. Keep the deck in an envelope.

4 Make your own

The last two cards are blank. Draw a face, write the feeling in your language, and fill in what you would say. Silly, tired, excited: any feeling your child has.

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